

Should Profit-Maximizing Firms be allowed to operate without strict regulations?

In today's global economy, profit-maximizing firms play a major role in economic growth and the productivity of a business. Even though this question of whether a profit-maximizing firm should be allowed to operate without strict regulations is highly debatable, it involves multiple perspectives. From a broader point, such firms shall not be operated without strict regulation, as they may cause significant risks to society, markets, and the environment. Apart from that, it reduces the public's trust and satisfaction in case of any fraud or unethical production, and this may be a short-term benefit for businesses, but this leads to long-term losses. While others might argue about a business's freedom of choice and creativity, in these situations, maintaining a balance between both the profit maximizing firms and ethical responsibility (CSR)- corporate social responsibility is essential for a successful business.

One such Multinational company with balance across both fields is Apple. It stands out as an example of a successful firm that follows CSR, their primary goal is to balance both the profits and social responsibilities, along with the public's interests and preferences, for ex apple, previously used to give chargers and earphones in their apple boxes, whereas since 2020 from their first launch of iphone 12 series they stopped giving chargers and earphones in apple boxes, as an effort to reduce electronic wastage and lowering carbon emissions, encouraging users to reuse their existing chargers and earphones, while previous apple users reuse their existing chargers and earphones, many new-apple buyers argue that it is extra money to buy for chargers and earphones, to end these concerns, and to compensate for these losses, apple has upgraded it hardware, with a15 chip, providing high-end cameras, super retina display, as a result, apple has stated that c chargers and earphones are not provided, the advanced hardware update is totally worth users extra expenses, so this new update, has not only benefited the environment and framed a good social perspective on apple, but also had reduces the packaging box size, allowing more iphones to be shipped, and reduced production and shipping cost for their company creating profit.



According to findings from a recent report, Apple has saved over \$6 billion and reduced its overall greenhouse gas emissions by more than 60% compared to 2015. This data suggests that Apple is taking close steps to achieve its aim of reducing e-waste and creating carbon-neutral products by the end of 2030.

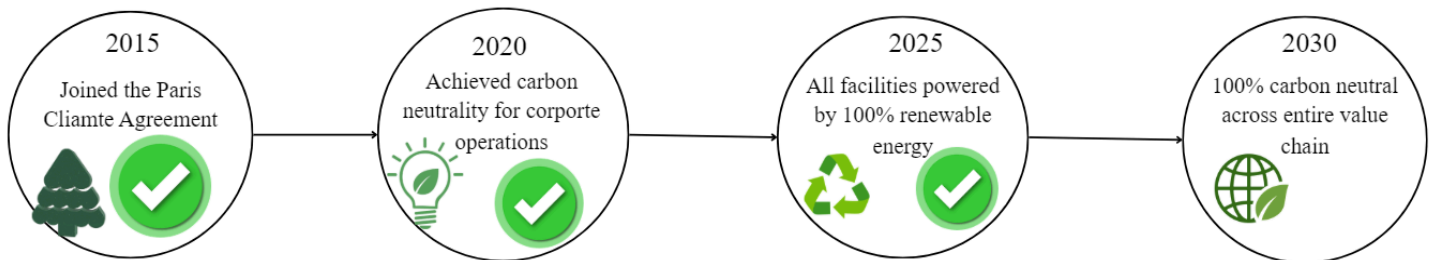
Apple sources the raw materials and components to create its devices from over 40 countries worldwide, across Asia, Europe, and the US, collecting rare minerals, however critics argue that the process of collecting these rare minerals in certain countries is harmful to the environment, and reported labour violations. In response to this criticism, Apple has uploaded a (Production and Supply Chain) report in their website, where 99% of recycled gold, tin and other minerals are used and ensuring that 1,856 total audits and assessments are filled by Apple workers to guarantee their safety and security requirements, proving there were no forceful labor violations, and most of the minerals are recycled to reduce the damage to environments.

Apple ethical sourcing behaviors have been underestimated by many analysts and researchers doubting the factory conditions and overtime working of laborers, facing this scepticism, Apple has launched its latest reports in February 2026, regarding their honest policies, that 1.4M+ supplier employees working hours per week is monitored constantly, verifying that they do not work over 60 hours following the legal rules and 665K+ employees are inspected in their workspace experience through interviews and their surveys.

Critics have also argued that Apple employs untrained workers with lack of experience, with labor issues and reported that less wages are paid to the workers and rights, proving these critics as wrong, the official Apple report website, had provided evidences of few of their employees assessment results, ensuring that 33M supplying workers have been trained properly since 2008, align with that 50+ human rights and environmental defenders are supported by Apple, and coming to the one major controversy of Labour issues, many employees working in China in (Foxconn -- multinational electronics manufacturer) have reported less wages and overtime working, however Apple only pays to the Foxconn assembly, and has no direct connection with the employees working in Foxconn, and this company not only produces for Apple, but also for Microsoft, Nintendo, etc., therefore there is no direct relation that Apple is the direct reason for this issue, supporting this assertion Apple has set high standards and regulations in partnering with those manufacturing companies.

Previously, Apple company had caused huge e-wastages, and increased carbon emissions, to produce more devices, but Apple had been working on this issue since the

recent years, to reuse precious and rare minerals to reduce wastage, For this reason, they have started Apple Trade-in Programs where apple users can return their old non-working phones for receiving an Apple gift card useful for purchasing other Apple products, encouraging more users to participate in these programs, then, after collecting those old phones, Apple had started using AI's like Daisy, Dave and Taz, which were created for removing minerals and certain parts from old phones to produce new devices, minimizing the e-wastage, along with this Apple had mainly adopted sustainability goals such as: carbon-neutrality goal, and clean energy programs etc...,



The above Infographic shows the Environmental Impact Apple has made in recent years and its goal to make in the following years as well.

In conclusion, these are the improvements Apple has been making in recent years to balance its profits with ethical behavior and responsibility towards society and the environment, along with maximizing profits for long-term benefits.

Bibliography:

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